DECODE UPSC with Mounika

Reel: India’s earthquake map

YouTube Short · about 95 seconds · Tuesday 3 Nov 2026

How to record this reel

- **Hold the phone upright (vertical)**, at eye level, about an arm’s length away. Frame from the top of your head to the middle of your chest, with a little space above your head. Set the camera to 1080p, 30 fps.
- **Light in front of you**, a plain or tidy background, and a quiet room.
- **Record the whole script in one take**, looking into the lens, with energy and a smile, as if talking to one student.
- **The first and last lines are full-face.** For the middle lines, your face shows at the top of the screen while the map and zones play below. Keep your head near the top-centre of the frame.
- If you make a mistake, pause, say “retake”, and read the sentence again.
- **Sending:** a 70-second video is usually 60–150 MB, too big for this chat. Upload it to Google Drive and send me the link (drive.google.com must be allowed in the environment’s network settings). Alternatively, record at **720p** in your camera settings; a 70-second clip is then often under 30 MB and can be sent here directly.

Script

SHORT — India’s earthquake map

📷 **FULL FACE — *curious, bright.***

India got a new earthquake map with a brand-new Zone 6. So why is the answer in your exam still Zone 5?

🎙️ **NARRATION**

First, who makes this map? The Bureau of Indian Standards, under the Ministry of Consumer Affairs, through its earthquake code, I-S 1893.

In November 2025 it released a new map. The old 2016 map has four zones; the new one added a sixth for the Himalayan arc, used probabilistic hazard modelling, moved boundary towns into the higher zone, and put about 61% of India in moderate to high hazard.

But in March 2026 the new code was withdrawn, after the Housing Ministry raised cost concerns, so the 2016 map is back in force.

And this is not a rumour: both the new map and its withdrawal were reported, so always check the date before you trust a map.

🎙️ **NARRATION — *slower.***

So India still has four zones: Zone 2, low; Zone 3, moderate; Zone 4, high; and Zone 5, very high.

🎙️ **NARRATION**

Zone 5 covers the North-East, parts of Kashmir, the Rann of Kutch, and the Andaman and Nicobar Islands.

Prelims trap: there is no Zone 1, Zone 6 is not in force, and the zones are set by the B-I-S, not by the Earth Sciences Ministry, which only records earthquakes.

📷 **FULL FACE — *warm, smile.***

Save this, and follow for one exam trap every day. The full weekly class is on Sunday.